JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff BI Analyst with 14 years of experience building data solutions that actually get used by the business. I've spent the last decade designing reporting infrastructure and mentoring junior analysts across financial services and retail sectors. I prefer working with pragmatic approaches to complex data problems rather than chasing the latest trends, and I've developed a reputation for translating messy business questions into clean analytical outputs.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior BI Analyst

Merkle Solutions

Liverpool, United Kingdom

www.merklesolutions.co

March 2021 - Present

Architected a new cloud-based analytics platform migrating 47 legacy reports from on-premise SQL Server, reducing query times by 68% and cutting infrastructure costs by 35,000 annually

Established the BI Centre of Excellence, creating coding standards and documentation that reduced report deployment time from 6 weeks to 3 weeks across a team of 8 analysts

Developed executive dashboards tracking KPIs across 12 business units, enabling leadership to make faster decisions on resource allocation and resulted in identified savings of 2.1 million in the first year

Mentored 4 junior analysts through their professional development, with 2 subsequently promoted to senior roles within 18 months

BI Analyst

Cornerstone Financial Group

Manchester, United Kingdom

October 2015 - February 2021

Built 34 automated reports in SQL Server and Tableau reducing manual spreadsheet work by 22 hours per week across the finance team

Created financial reconciliation dashboards tracking daily settlements across 8 trading desks, identifying discrepancies within hours instead of days and preventing 4 significant errors

Redesigned the data warehouse schema for customer metrics improving query performance by 71% and enabling self-service reporting for non-technical users

Partnered with IT to implement row-level security protocols ensuring compliance with regulatory requirements across all analytics platforms

Business Intelligence Developer

DataVision Analytics

Liverpool, United Kingdom

www.datavision.io

June 2010 - September 2015

Developed ETL processes using SQL and SSIS to extract data from 12 different source systems consolidating retail sales and inventory data into a single warehouse serving 30+ reports

Created Cognos reports for operations and marketing teams providing visibility into sales performance and campaign effectiveness across 150+ retail locations

Maintained and optimized the core data warehouse supporting 150,000 daily queries and achieving 99.2% uptime throughout 5-year tenure

Documented all data definitions and business logic creating a knowledge base that reduced onboarding time for new team members from 8 weeks to 3 weeks

EDUCATION

BSc Mathematics and Statistics

University of Liverpool

Liverpool, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2010

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Databases: SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Oracle

Data Warehousing: Data vault methodology, dimensional modeling, ETL design

BI Tools: Tableau, Power BI, Cognos, QlikView

Programming: SQL, Python, VBA

Cloud Platforms: Azure, AWS Redshift

Visualization: Tableau, Power BI, Excel

Other: SSIS, Apache Airflow, Git